

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
MARTINEZ, CA
DEPARTMENT 16
JUDICIAL OFFICER: BENJAMIN T REYES II
HEARING DATE: 05/06/2026

**INSTRUCTIONS FOR CONTESTING TENTATIVE RULING IN
DEPARTMENT 16**

The tentative ruling will become the ruling of the Court unless by 4:00 P.M. of the Court day preceding the hearing, notice is given of an intent to argue the matter. Counsel or self-represented parties must email Department 16 (Dept16@contracosta.courts.ca.gov) to request argument and **must specify, in detail, what provision(s) of the tentative ruling they intend to argue and why.** Counsel or self-represented parties requesting argument must advise all other counsel and self-represented parties by no later than 4:00 P.M. of their decision to argue, and of the issues to be argued. Failure to timely advise the Court and counsel or self-represented parties will preclude any party from arguing the matter. (Pursuant to Local Rule 3.43(2).)

The prevailing party must prepare and e-file a proposed order after hearing in accordance with CRC 3.1312. The order must include appearances. If the tentative ruling becomes the Court's ruling, a copy of the Court's tentative ruling **must be attached to the proposed order** when submitted to the Court for issuance of the order.

ALL APPEARANCES TO ARGUE WILL BE IN PERSON OR BY ZOOM, PROVIDED THAT PROPER NOTIFICATION IS RECEIVED BY THE DEPARTMENT AS PER ABOVE.

Zoom link-

<https://www.zoomgov.com/j/1619504895?pwd=NOV1N3JFRnJ0TEVoSDNrTGRzakF3UT09>

ID: 161 950 4895

Password: 812674

Courtroom Clerk's Session

1. 8:31 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-00085
CASE NAME: LAURA BEGIN VS. SAN RAMON VALLEY FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT
*TRIAL SETTING CONFERENCE TO TRAIL SUMMARY JUDGMENT ALREADY ON CALENDAR
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

On the Court's own motion, the Trial Setting Conference (TSC) is continued to June 3, 2026.

2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-01442
CASE NAME: SIOBHAN DUFALL VS. ROLANDO GUTIERREZ
*FURTHER CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

The case has settled. The Case Management Conference is **continued** to July 9, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. in Department 16 as a dismissal review hearing. If a dismissal has been filed before that date, the hearing will be vacated.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01961
CASE NAME: WILLIAM DEDMAN VS. BRIAN HOWARD
***CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE TO FOLLOW-UP ON JUDGMENT POST JURY TRIAL**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on the Motion for Judgment Notwithstanding the Verdict, Line 13. This hearing is vacated due to the May 5, 2026 filing by Defendant Nataliya Howard of a Motion to Disqualify Judge Reyes. No appearance is required.

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02810
CASE NAME: DOMINGA ELEANOR ULIBARRY JIMENEZ VS. TERRICE WARREN
***FURTHER CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on the Motion for Sanctions, Line 15. Counsel are ordered to appear for the CMC either in person or remotely. If the Tentative Ruling for Line 6 is uncontested, this CMC is continued to September 4, 2026 at 8:30am.

Law & Motion

5. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-00085
CASE NAME: LAURA BEGIN VS. SAN RAMON VALLEY FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT
HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION RE DEFENDANTS SAN RAMON VALLEY FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT AND JOHN DUGGAN
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

Continued by the Court, *sua sponte*, to June 3, 2026.

6. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-01442
CASE NAME: SIOBHAN DUFALL VS. ROLANDO GUTIERREZ
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: RECONSIDERATION OF AN ORDER ADOPTING THE 11/19/25 TENTATIVE RULING GRANTING ARCH INSURANCE COMPANY'S MOTION FOR LEAVE TO FILE A COMPLAINT IN INTERVENTION**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff's motion under CCP sections 473(b) and 1008 is **off calendar** based on Plaintiff's withdrawal